TEXTO 01

Bulletproof steel shelters sold as solution to school shootings

They're an alarming symbol of an American crisis. Do they represent our inevitable future?

1. A company in Fort Pierce, Florida – not far from 2.Parkland, site of the 2018 school shooting that 3.killed 17 – is stirring controversy with its plan to 4.protect children from school shootings by hiding 5.them in bullet-resistant steel enclosures. To many, 6.the idea of directing children into stark metal 7.boxes serves as an alarming symbol of a country 8.that fails time and again to address the causes of 9.its gun violence crisis. But with Congress stymied, 10.decade after decade, on gun control, and mass 11.shootings only growing deadlier and more 12.common, do the pods represent a disturbing – 13.but inevitable – safety measure? John Corrado, 14.vice-president of National Safety Shelters, says 15.the company sees its shelters as a response to an 16.intractable problem. "Obviously, the fewer the 17.guns, the better. Because you can't have 18.shootings without guns," Corrado says. "However, 19.we've recognized reality. With the type of 20.government that we have and the difficulty in 21.getting laws changed … guns are here to stay. So 22.you have to do something to protect yourself 23.from them." The idea, he says, is that the pods 24.would be just one part of a "comprehensive 25.solution". Children, the company says, can enter 26.the shelters in the event of an attack "within a 27.minute or less". The pods, intended to 28.accommodate a classroom's worth of people, are 29.built from "military-grade steel specially heat-30.treated to resist not only all handguns and 31.shotguns, but even semi-automatic weapons like 32.AK-47 and AR-15 rifles", according to the 33.company. The idea is that each classroom would 34.have its own shelter, which locks from the inside 35.with three bolts and a locking pin. The company 36.began as a mobility lift company, building 37.equipment to assist disabled people, Corrado 38.says. One of its suppliers was a company that 39.built above-ground tornado shelters in Missouri. 40."After the shootings took place in Sandy Hook at 41.the end of 2012, a few schools in their 42.neighboring areas started inquiring of them 43.saying, 'Hey, could we put these shelters perhaps 44.in classrooms, to protect kids?'" Corrado says. 45."What really got us deeply into it was in 2018, 46.when the Parkland shooting happened, because 47.that's close to home for us … the Parkland school 48.is about an hour and a half from where we live." 49.That year, a federal report called for "secure 50.spaces within classrooms where students and 51.teachers can shelter". The company began 52.marketing the pods as protection against 53.shooters and tornadoes. Since then, the company 54.has worked with several other schools and some 55.daycares, Corrado says. So far, the pods have 56.not been used in any real-world shootings, he 57.says, though Quitman did use them during a 58.tornado scare. Meanwhile, a handful of other 59.midwestern tornado-shelter makers have "started 60.to rebrand them as safety shelters". But Ron Avi 61.Astor, a professor of social welfare at UCLA's 62.Luskin School of Public Affairs and School of 63.Education and Information Studies, says there's 64.a lack of evidence to support measures like these 65.that make schools more fortress-like. For one 66.thing, he says, many "hardening" responses 67.assume the intruder is coming from the outside, 68.when many attackers are current or former 69.students who will be aware of the school's 70.deterrents and may be able to circumvent them.

71.Astor is concerned about the "long-term effects of 72.kids growing up in mini-prisons". "Imagine 13 73.years being in that kind of building. There is a lot 74.of data showing that particularly for kids in 75.urban, low income areas, having a lot of these 76.measures, dogs, police officers: everything 77.actually creates a higher level of dropout and 78.increases the school-to-prison pipeline." School 79.becomes, "a place of fear". In the short term, he 80.says, we may need to find a plan that balances 81."where we want to be as a society with relieving 82.some of the anxieties" about attacks. He calls for 83.developing programs that build connections 84.between children and their schools, "so that every 85.teacher knows a little bit about every child's 86.emotional life and a little bit about their 87.parents", he says.

QUESTION 01: According to the article, the company in Fort Pierce, Florida, is selling

a) bulletproof jackets for children
b) bullet-resistant steel enclosures
c) bulletproof backpacks for students
d) bullet-resistant school buses

QUESTION 02: The main concern with the use of steel enclosures in schools is that

a) they are too expensive
b) they are not effective against mass shootings
c) they are not aesthetically pleasing
d) they are a symbol of a country that fails to address gun violence

QUESTION 03: John Corrado stated that steel enclosures are necessary to

a) promote gun control laws in Congress
b) eliminate guns from society
c) protect children from gun violence, which is an intractable problem
d) make schools more fortress-like

QUESTION 04: Children can enter the steel enclosures in

a) more than a minute
b) less than a minute
c) five minutes
d) ten minutes

QUESTION 05: The enclosures are made of

a) glass
b) concrete
c) wood
d) steel

QUESTION 06: The purpose of the three bolts and locking pin on the steel enclosures is

a) to make it easier to open
b) to make it more difficult to open from the outside
c) to make it more difficult to open from the inside
d) to prevent children from using the enclosures

QUESTION 07: National Safety Shelters started making steel enclosures for schools by

a) building tornado shelters in Missouri
b) manufacturing military-grade steel for the government
c) designing protective gear for law enforcement officers
d) working with schools to improve their security measures

QUESTION 08: Talking about the use, the steel enclosures

a) have been used in many shootings across the country
b) have not been used in any shootings
c) have been used only once, in the Parkland shooting
d) were banned before they could be used in any shootings

QUESTION 09: Ron Avi Astor's concern with the use of steel enclosures in schools is that

a) they are not effective against mass shootings
b) they make schools too fortress-like
c) they are too expensive
d) they create a place of fear and have negative long-term effects on children

QUESTION 10: As an alternative to steel enclosures, Ron Avi Astor suggests

a) more police officers and dogs in schools
b) improving gun control laws in Congress
c) developing programs that build connections between children and their schools
d) building more fortresses around schools